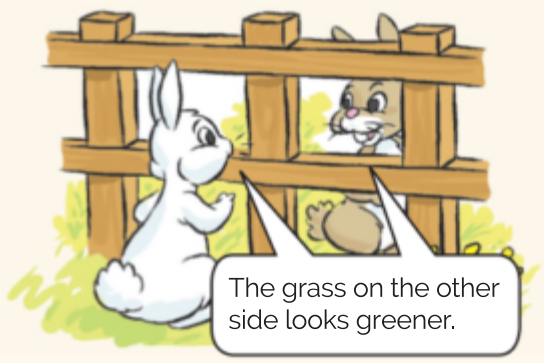
9 The Princess

Warm up

What does this cartoon show? Which rabbit do you think is right? Do we often think that what someone else has or gets to do is better than what we have or get to do?



Let's read a story where Patty Jean thinks the special treatment her sister, Penny, gets is unfair, until one day she decides to try out things for herself.

My older sister is ten years old. Her name is Penelope Piper, but everyone calls her Penny. Everyone except me. I, Patty Jean Piper, call her 'the Princess'. It's the perfect name for her. All day she just sits on her throne with wheels and tells everybody in the whole world what to do.

Why does Patty call her sister 'the Princess'?

When we go shopping at the mall, the Princess rides on her throne while Father wheels her around, along the aisle and I, Patty Jean, carry packages. Sometimes there are so many, I look like a box with legs. My school is so far from my house; I have to ride for hours on a school bus to get there. The Princess goes to the new school right across the street. She can wheel herself there in one second. She does not even have to wear a uniform!

It is summer now. All my friends have gone to camp—everyone except me. Mother says there's no money to send me to camp because the Princess has just got new braces for her legs.

After dinner I go outside. The Princess is in the hammock, asleep. Beside the tree is the throne. Seeing it empty gives me the best idea. Today I will be the Princess!

I sit on the throne. 'Now I will spend *every minute* on the throne,' I say.

throne: a special chair where a king or queen sits
aisle: a passage between rows of shelves in a supermarket
braces: a device that supports weak parts of the body
hammock: a type of bed made from a net or from a piece of strong fabric, with ropes at each end that are used to hang it between two trees, posts, etc.

I decide to ride to the Princess' school. There is a nice, steep little hill on the grass near the sidewalk. Maybe it would be fun to ride down it. I sit down and give the throne a good, hard push. PLOP! The throne dumps me out on the sidewalk and lands upside down on top of me.

My knee has a tiny cut on it. I'm glad no one is around to laugh. I wonder if the Princess ever fell when she was learning to ride the throne. I put the throne right side up and get back on it.

Then I ride to the corner of the street. I've been pushing so hard that I feel like both my arms are broken. Some grown-ups are walking towards me. They look at me and my throne, and then they turn away fast, like I do when I'm watching a scary movie. Does this happen to the Princess? Some boys are playing on the sidewalk and will not move out of my way. 'Why don't you go over me, Wheel Legs?' says one of them. All his friends laugh. 'I'll beat you up!' I yell, but they just laugh some more and run away.

The worst thing in the world has happened. Great big raindrops have started falling over everything! The rain comes faster and faster. I think about running home, but I can't leave the throne out in the rain. The wheels of the throne sink down, down, down in the mud. By the time I pull the throne out, I am wetter and colder than I have ever been in my whole life.

What do people do when they see Patty Jean on the 'throne'?

What do you think Patty Jean realizes as she moves around on her sister's chair?

The rain stops. I wheel myself home. I notice Father standing in our front yard. He is calling and calling, but the cars and trucks are so noisy that I can't hear him. Mother is walking up the street, looking around anxiously. I drag the muddy throne across the rest of the field to the sidewalk. When Mother sees me, she runs and

steep: rising or falling quickly, not gradually
sidewalk: the pavement on the side of the road used for walking
yard: a piece of land next to or around a house usually with an area of grass

holds out her arms. Father is right behind her. 'I didn't mean to mess up the throne. I'm sorry,' I say. 'Throne?' says Mother. 'Oh, the *wheelchair*. We thought you were lost!' 'You weren't looking for the chair?' I say. 'Patty Jean, we were looking for *you*.' Mother hugs me some more. 'You shouldn't have taken Penny's chair. But we're so glad you're back!'

Mother washes me in the bathtub and puts me to bed just like she does for Penny. After Father and Mother say goodnight and turn out the lights, I lie there thinking. 'Penny,' I whisper. 'Are you awake?'

'Uh-huh.'

'How can you smile all the time when you're in that yucky chair?'

'It's not yucky,' says Penny. 'It takes me places.'

'I'm sorry I took your chair,' I say.

'That's all right. Just go to sleep now.'

Why do you think Patty Jean lies wide awake? What is she thinking about?

But I'm wide awake. I lie there and wish very hard that my sister will always be able to do things that make her happy.

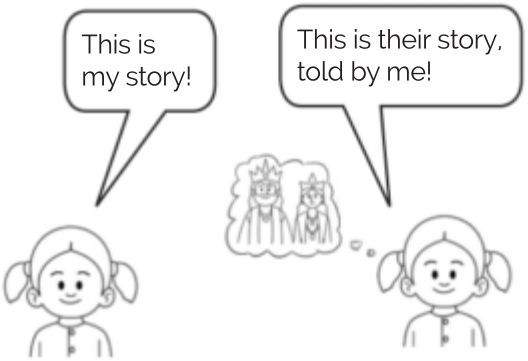
Make connections

In this section, we will:
- remember details about the story.
- learn how to analyse the structure of a story. (C-2.1, C-2.2)

Map the story

Answer the following questions based on the story.

1. In a story, the first-person point of view is when a character tells the story, while the third-person point of view is when the narrator tells it. This story uses the first-person point of view because Patty Jean is telling it. Tick the sentences that show Patty Jean is telling the story.
   a. My older sister is ten years old. ○
   b. Patty Jean's sister is ten years old. ○
   c. The Princess is in the hammock, asleep. ○
   d. Patty Jean sees Penny in the hammock, asleep. ○
   e. Today I will be the Princess! ○
   f. Patty Jean wants to be the Princess! ○



mess up: to spoil something or do it badly

2. Story plots have a beginning, a middle and an end. Patty Jean wrote down the things that happened to her when she took a ride on 'the throne', but she mixed up the order of events. Help her put the events in the correct order. Write B for the events that take place in the beginning, M for the events in the middle and E for the events in the end.

   a. A group of boys laughed at Patty Jean. ○
   b. Penny was sleeping in the hammock. ○
   c. Patty Jean saw the wheelchair was empty. ○
   d. It began to rain and the wheelchair got stuck in the mud. ○
   e. Patty Jean apologized to Penny. She wished Penny would always be able to do things that would make her happy. ○
   f. It stopped raining and Patty Jean got home. ○
   g. Patty Jean decided to ride the wheelchair to Penny's school. ○
   h. Patty Jean's hands began to hurt. ○
   i. Patty Jean's parents put her to bed and said goodnight. ○

Deep dive

Answer the following questions with reference to context.

1. *I, Patty Jean Piper, call her 'the Princess'. It's the perfect name for her.*

RECALL	INFER	ANALYSE
a. Who was 'the Princess'? b. Why did the narrator call that person 'the Princess'?	c. Do you think the narrator was aware of the problems 'the Princess' had to deal with? Give reasons for your answer.	d. Do you agree with Patty Jean that 'the Princess' was a good name for Penny? Give reasons for your answer.

2. *'How can you smile all the time when you're in that yucky chair?'*

RECALL	INFER	ANALYSE
a. What had happened that had made the narrator call the chair 'yucky'?	b. Do you think the narrator's feelings towards her sister changed after what she experienced in that 'yucky chair'? Explain your answer.	c. What does this line tell us about Penny's character?

Read, reflect and write

1. Why had Patty Jean not gone to camp like all her other friends?
2. Why do you think the grown-ups turned away when they looked at Patty Jean?
3. What did Patty Jean think when she first saw her parents outside the house? Do you think she expected them to be angry? Explain your answer.

Integrate

Is there a playground around your house? Check whether the playground can be used by children who use wheelchairs. Plan a visit to the playground with an adult. Make a list of everything you need to check. Think about ramps, playground equipments, wide spaces, surfaces or other features that might be helpful.

Word wall

In this section, we will:
- practise vocabulary using zig-zag word puzzles.
- identify and find opposite gender words.

(C-4.1, 4.2)

Zig-zag word puzzles

Continue the zig-zag word puzzles given below. Each word in the sets start with the last two letters of the previous word.

A	I	S	L	E
L	E	A	S	H
		A		
		M		
		I		

T	H	R	O	N	E
N	E	C	T	A	R
		T	I		
		A	B		
		N	T		

Make more such sets of your own starting with a word from the story.

Gender

Find words in the puzzle that mean the opposite of the gendered words given in the box.

nephew uncle headmaster sir emperor groom monk gentlemen husband

Z	A	N	I	E	C	E	H	N	Q	F	F
Z	U	S	I	I	F	B	R	I	D	E	G
S	N	E	R	E	M	P	R	E	S	S	X
L	T	L	K	T	N	U	N	U	B	C	T
H	E	A	D	M	I	S	T	R	E	S	S
R	T	M	L	A	D	I	E	S	N	N	I
T	M	O	R	Q	U	W	I	F	E	I	C
L	E	Y	Y	X	Q	M	A	D	A	M	J

Grammar time

In this section, we will:
- learn about prepositions and where to use them. (C-3.4)

Prepositions

Read these sentences.

- The Princess rides on her throne while Father wheels her around, along the aisle.
- I drag the muddy throne across the rest of the field to the sidewalk.

The words highlighted above are prepositions.

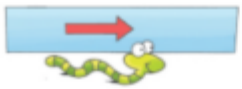
A preposition is a word that usually goes before a noun (or a pronoun) to show the relationship of the noun to another word in a sentence.

Around, *along* and *across* are prepositions of movement.

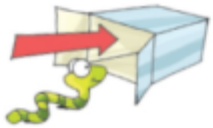
- Along and around show us where and how Father is wheeling the Princess.
- Across shows us where Patty Jean is dragging the wheelchair.

ANCHOR CHART

When prepositions are used to show us the movement of people and things, we call them prepositions of movement.

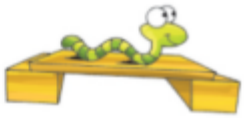

along

over


into

upon

across


on

through

around

1. Patty Jean takes a walk. Given below are some pictures to show where she went. Match the pictures to the prepositions to show where Patty Jean is walking. One has been done for you.

a.

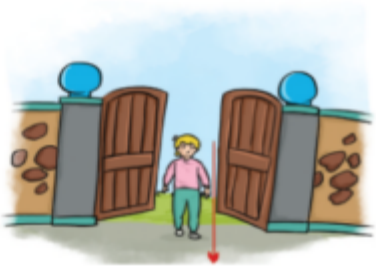
b.

c.

d.

e.

f.



through

into

along

around

across

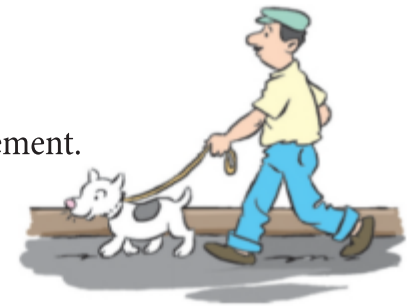
past

2. Use the words in the box to complete the sentences describing each picture.

across	into	along	through	over

a. The train is going _____ the tunnel.

b. The man is walking his dog _____ the pavement.



c. The footballer is running _____ the field.

d. The woman is driving the truck _____ the bridge.

e. The cat jumped _____ the box to take a nap.

3. Use any five prepositions of movement you have learnt in sentences of your own.

In this section, we will:
- learn about exceptions to using *an*. (C-1.1)

Pronunciation

Exceptions to using an

Read this sentence.

- She does not even have to wear a uniform!

Do you know why we say a uniform instead of an uniform?

1. Say these words aloud with your teacher. Notice how, although they all start with u, some of them have a /y/ sound.

umbrella untidy unicorn united uphill unusual used ugly useful

2. Read the words given above on your own and circle the ones with the /y/ sound.

When we use these words with the /y/ sound, we put the article a instead of an in front of them.

3. Fill in a or an in these sentences.

a. Wearing _____ uniform to school looks smart.

b. I must buy _____ umbrella before the monsoon sets in.

c. It is _____ uphill ride to the fort.

d. Let us make something out of _____ used sheet of paper instead of wasting a new one.

e. The computer is _____ useful machine.

4. The h is silent in words like hour, honest and honour. So we use an before these words. Make sentences of your own with these three words.

1. _____

_____

2. _____

_____

3. _____

_____

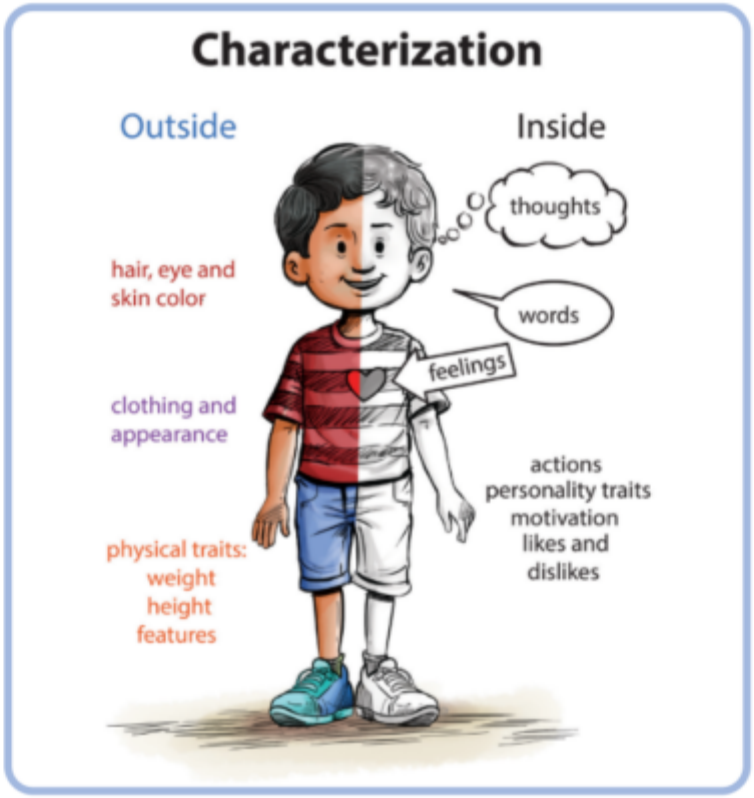
In this section, we will:
- learn how to write about ourselves, on the inside and the outside. (C-3.2, 3.4)

Write well

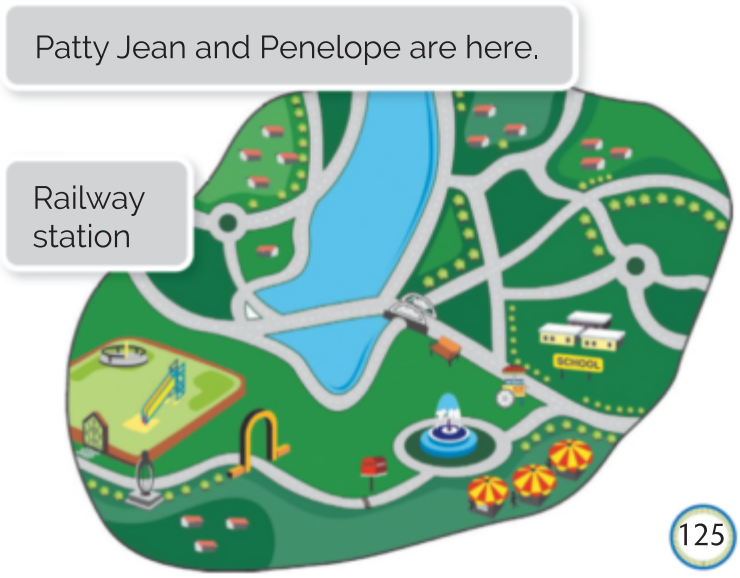
Writing about yourself

When we look at the characters in a story, we look at them on the outside and on the inside.

Think about yourself and write a short composition in your notebook about you on the outside (your features, what you like to wear) and you on the inside (your thoughts, feelings, likes and dislikes).



In this section, we will:
- listen to some information and mark a route on a map.
- practise giving each other directions. (C-1.1, 2.1)

Listen and speak well

1. **Patty Jean and her sister, Penelope, decide to go to the park. Listen to the route they take and mark it on the map.**
2. **Now, work in pairs and give each other directions**
   a. from the park to the railway station.
   b. from the railway station to the school.